

Type 1 in pregnancy

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Type 1 diabetes and pregnancy | Diabetes UK

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Type 1 diabetes and pregnancy

Can you give birth if you have type 1 diabetes? Women with type 1 diabetes can have a safe pregnancy and give birth to a healthy baby but won't always be able to have a vaginal delivery. If you have type 1 diabetes, your baby can be larger. And because there are risks with having a larger baby you might need to have your baby early and be induced at week 37 or 38 or you might need to have a Caesarean section (an incision in your womb) rather than a vaginal delivery. Your maternity team will chat to you about what's best for you and the baby. Women are advised to plan for pregnancy with their healthcare team before coming off contraception to reduce the risks to their health and their baby's. If you have an unplanned pregnancy, don't be hard on yourself and don't panic. As soon as you find out you're pregnant, get in touch with your diabetes healthcare team. They should get back to you with advice and appointments for health checks for you both.

Will having type 1 diabetes during pregnancy affect the baby? Most women with type 1 diabetes have healthy babies. But pregnancy hormones can make it harder to keep your blood sugar levels within target range. And if you have high blood sugar levels, this can affect your baby's development. It can cause birth defects, make babies larger and increase the risk of a difficult birth, and the risk of miscarriage and stillbirth. Shortly after birth, some babies might need admission to the neonatal care unit for problems such as low blood sugar levels and jaundice and may need support with heart and breathing problems. To reduce the risks to your baby's health, it's important to tell your diabetes healthcare team you want to try for a baby so they can help you plan. To help monitor your baby's health and your health, you'll get extra appointments, checks and scans from your maternity diabetes teams throughout the pregnancy. You should be seen by your healthcare team every two weeks. And you'll usually give birth in hospital. Can type 1 diabetes be passed from mother to baby? Babies aren't born with type 1 diabetes. And there's only a slightly higher risk of your child developing the condition later on. For more information, see our page on [Causes of type 1 diabetes](#). Many people with type 1 diabetes have no family history. Planning for a pregnancy if you have type 1 diabetes Planning your pregnancy can help you reduce the risk of serious health complications for you and your baby. Ideally, you'll start seeing your healthcare team at least 6-12 months before stopping contraception, so they can help you prepare for a healthy pregnancy. Your healthcare team can support you to reach a HbA1c of 48mmol/mol or lower. Any reduction towards the target will help protect your baby. The first 6-8 weeks is when the baby's organs develop which is why it's important to get support with blood glucose management before you get pregnant. If your HbA1c is above 86mmols/mol it is strongly rec

"With my first pregnancy, I came off contraception thinking it would take a while to get pregnant and I had time to plan. But I fell pregnant straight away. And the enormity of the situation hit home and what it all meant." Read Charlotte's story

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